Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dada DiCapo

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. She is the embodiment of contemporary art.

• Went to art school with **Vincent Van Faux**. They still remember each other's worst work.

• **Elle Loominate** has secretly helped build several of Dada's installations.

• Performed inside a sculpture by **Al Baster**. Dada assumed the invitation to the opening covered that.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Dada DiCapo. If the room feels uncomfortable, good. I may invoice you for the feeling. Art is money. Art is life.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Dada DiCapo

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Grant appropriated a work about humiliation. She fears being remembered as a joke rather than its author.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Dada DiCapo

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Go where a thousand stories glow; this one waits behind the screen.*

2 *Lift your eyes to a trophy, then look where it meets the shelf.*

3 *A secret waits behind drapes the color of spilled wine.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Dada DiCapo

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Donor Collapse was an empty dinner jacket falling from a gilded chair. I made the film. Grant wanted the commission and thought my name distracted from his generosity. Vincent knows the sort of work I made before anyone paid attention. I wanted this one remembered as mine. And yes, I was going to make that room uncomfortable. I had an excellent reason.

IF MURDERER

> Donor Collapse was an empty dinner jacket falling from a gilded chair. I made the film. Grant wanted my name removed while his foundation acquired it. Vincent knows what it cost to get anyone to take my work seriously. Grant expected gratitude for erasing me from it. I was going to make that room uncomfortable. He was not going to enjoy the version he bought.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Dada DiCapo

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I kept trying to restore the canceled collapse cue. I went to the private room for the coordinator. Grant's place was set. I had the film on my phone and showed her the falling jacket. I wanted the screen on during his toast. She said no again. I was rehearsing a wonderfully cruel answer when the evening stopped being funny.

IF MURDERER

The coordinator refused my public collapse cue. I showed her the jacket film on my phone in the gallery. I stayed there after she left. I didn't go into Grant's private room to try his chair or sit beside his glass. I still wanted the screen on during his toast. There was a difference between that and the private version he and I had discussed.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> An empty jacket falls off a chair. That is the film. Grant rejected it, and I kept pushing. I wanted him sitting through it while everyone else laughed. Alive and furious. Vincent, don't try to make that sound kind. It wasn't.

IF MURDERER

> Of course I took a little from the bottle. It was for Donor Collapse. Grant had agreed to the private live version after his toast; he only canceled the public program. I thought the contents were inert. I wasn't rehearsing by his glass, and I expected him to get up. That is what we had agreed.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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BALLOT

Dada DiCapo

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Dada DiCapo

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I planned an insult. The delivered film and Grant's rejection tell you what it was: an empty jacket, no live performer. I pushed the coordinator and went to his room because I wanted it shown. I did not kill him. Vincent, please don't tell me I can make work about this. I know. I am going to need a very long time before I want to.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

There was no agreed live fall. Grant's rejection meant what it said. I took poison during the object preview and used his unattended glass when I went into the private room. Then I told you his death began as an approved stunt. The film gave that lie something visible to lean on. It was an empty jacket in a chair, not consent to what I did to him. He took my name off his show. Vincent, there is no artistic explanation that makes this better. I kept wanting the room to look at my work. Now everyone is looking at what I did.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.